

uct or contests and help reach the target audience. SMS-based quizzes help marketers understand the style preferences of mobile owners. Such SMS promos may be devised in conjunction with print, TV, Radio and/or online campaigns. Yet, all advertisers need to understand that effective mobile marketing is pull-based and not push (spam)-based.

Wireless marketing involves delivering attractive downloadable content to the target audience. In India, marketers are tapping the increasing base of potential buyers. The more recent and successful SMS campaigns include the *Indian Idol* show. To retain the consumer's interest (here, the viewers), these campaigns are usually backed by gifts and prizes.

Film production houses are increasingly using this medium for marketing their films. There are unlimited SMS solutions through which marketers can promote their various offers. Nevertheless, mobile marketing is still at a nascent stage. Mobile solution providers are also working hard at making mobile marketing a popular phenomenon in India. All are spin-offs of mobile commerce, popularly called m-commerce.

At the same time, in the name of mobile marketing, users receive too many SMSes every day. It is therefore important to safeguard the mobile marketing channel as advertisers increasingly adopt the SMS medium. It is imperative that advertisers allow people the option of receiving/subscribing to each mobile marketing program separately. Such targeted communication is less likely to annoy consumers, and can prevent mobile spamming.

7.7 Cell Phone Usage And Society

Courtesy high mobile telephone penetration, a certain “mobile culture” has evolved, and the cell phone has become a must-have to keep up with your peers and at work. The culture spawned by mobile phones extends beyond mere talking and SMSing.